

01 - Comparative Cosmology Feature Spec

Comparative Cosmology Feature — Specification & Content

Feature working title: *The Source Map* (alt: *Pleromic Atlas, Convergence Engine*)

Methodology label (for users): Comparative Esotericism / Perennial Cosmology — mapping the Source across traditions using the Gnostic four-tier framework as the interpretive key.

Intellectual lineage to cite in About section: Pico della Mirandola's *Oratio*, Ficino's *Prisca Theologia*, Manly P. Hall's *The Secret Teachings of All Ages*, Blavatsky's *The Secret Doctrine*, René Guénon's Traditionalism, Wouter Hanegraaff's academic comparative esotericism.

1. Core concept

A user-explorable neural-network-style interface where every documented deity, divine concept, and cosmological figure across world traditions is mapped onto a **four-tier vertical hierarchy** derived from Gnostic cosmology. Users can:

- See nodes (deities/concepts) grouped by structural function, not by religion
- Draw or trace **connection lines** between parallel figures across traditions
- Save their own connections (“my map”) as a personal layer
- Click any node for source texts, etymology, and proponent claims
- Toggle traditions on/off to focus comparisons

This is *not* a flat encyclopedia. It is a **structural map** where position on the canvas = cosmological function.

2. The four-tier structural framework

This is the master schema. Every entity in the database is tagged with one of these tiers.

TIER 1 — The Unmanifest Source (the Monad)

The unknowable, ineffable, beyond-being ground of reality. Not a person. Not a creator. The substrate from which all emanation proceeds.

Cross-traditional names:

- **Gnostic:** The Monad, Bythos (“the Depth”), the Invisible Spirit, the One, the Pleroma (as totality)
- **Kabbalah:** Ein Sof (“the Limitless”)
- **Hindu/Vedic:** Brahman (Nirguna — without attributes), Parabrahman
- **Taoist:** The Tao (that which cannot be named)
- **Neoplatonic:** The One (Plotinus), the Good (Plato)
- **Hermetic:** The All, the Nous in its highest sense
- **Buddhist:** Sunyata (emptiness), Dharmakaya
- **Egyptian:** Nun (the primordial waters/void before form), Amun (the hidden)
- **Norse:** Ginnungagap (the void before being)
- **Sufi:** Al-Haqq (The Real), the Hidden Treasure
- **Christian apophatic:** the Godhead beyond God (Meister Eckhart), the Divine Darkness (Pseudo-Dionysius)

TIER 2 — The True Most High / Divine Council (El Elyon / the Pleroma)

The first manifestation. The Father of Aeons. Head of the divine council. The level Lucifer/Yaldabaoth tried to usurp. Still divine, still aligned with Source.

Cross-traditional names:

- **Gnostic:** The Father, the Aeons, Barbelo, the Pleroma (as inhabited fullness)
- **Hebrew (older layer):** El Elyon (“God Most High”), the Elohim (divine council), the sons of God (bene ha-elohim)
- **Canaanite:** El (chief of the divine council at Mount Saphon)
- **Greek:** The Demiurge of Plato’s *Timaeus* in its benevolent reading; the Nous; the Logos
- **Hindu:** Saguna Brahman, Ishvara, Brahma in his cosmic-creator aspect
- **Egyptian:** Atum-Ra emerging from Nun; the Ogdoad
- **Norse:** The Aesir collectively under Odin’s leadership (council aspect)
- **Mesopotamian:** Anu (sky-father), the Anunnaki council
- **Zoroastrian:** Ahura Mazda
- **Kabbalah:** Keter and the upper Sephiroth; the Adam Kadmon

TIER 3 — The Demiurge (Yaldabaoth / Yahweh / Lucifer)

The flawed craftsman who fashioned the material world. Believes himself to be the only God. The figure who tried to ascend above the true Most High. Jealous, demanding, sacrificial. The “god of this world.”

Cross-traditional names and identifications:

- **Gnostic:** Yaldabaoth, Saklas (“fool”), Samael (“blind god”), the Demiurge
- **Old Testament (Gnostic reading):** Yahweh, the jealous god of Sinai
- **Christian (esoteric reading):** Lucifer-as-usurper, the “god of this world” (2 Cor 4:4), the prince of the power of the air
- **Platonic:** The Demiurge of the *Timaeus* in its ignorant-craftsman reading
- **Mesopotamian:** Marduk (slays Tiamat and fashions world from her corpse), Enlil (often punitive)
- **Egyptian:** Set in his usurper aspect; some readings of Khnum the potter
- **Hindu:** Brahma in his egoic/limited aspect (cf. the myth where Brahma is humbled by Vishnu and Shiva)
- **Norse:** Odin in his binding/sacrificial aspect (parallel, though Norse cosmology resists the mapping)
- **Greek:** Zeus as tyrant (vs. Prometheus), Kronos devouring his children
- **Kabbalah:** The realm of the Qliphoth; in some readings, the lower partzufim before tikkun

TIER 4 — The Archons / Rulers / Planetary Powers

The Demiurge’s subordinates. Enforcers of the material order. The “powers and principalities.”

Cross-traditional names:

- **Gnostic:** The seven Archons (one per classical planet), often named after Yaldabaoth’s offspring
- **Hebrew:** The watchers (Enoch), the fallen angels, the princes of nations (Daniel)
- **Greek/Roman:** The Olympian council in their planetary-ruler aspect; the daimones
- **Hindu:** The Lokapalas (directional guardians), the Devas in their limiting aspect
- **Mesopotamian:** The Igigi, the seven Anunnaki judges
- **Zoroastrian:** The Daevas
- **Egyptian:** The 42 assessors of Ma’at; the neteru in their punitive aspect
- **Christian:** Principalities, powers, thrones, dominions (Eph 6:12)
- **Hermetic:** The seven governors of the *Poimandres*
- **Kabbalah:** The Sarim (princes) of the nations

Cross-tier figures (the Light-Bringers / Liberators / Mediators)

Figures who do not fit neatly in one tier because they *bridge* tiers — typically descending from Source to wake humanity from the Demiurge's sleep.

- **Gnostic:** Christ-Aeon, Sophia (in her redemptive aspect), the Serpent of Eden (Ophite reading), Seth, Barbelo as mediator
 - **Greek:** Prometheus, Hermes (psychopomp/messenger), Dionysus (descending god)
 - **Norse:** Loki (fire/trickster/liberator), Odin in his wisdom-seeking aspect
 - **Mesopotamian:** Enki/Ea (warns Atrahasis/Utnapishtim, brings wisdom)
 - **Egyptian:** Thoth (wisdom mediator), Osiris (dying-rising god)
 - **Hindu:** Krishna and the avatars of Vishnu, Shiva as Dakshinamurti (teacher)
 - **Christian (orthodox):** Christ as descending Logos
 - **Buddhist:** Bodhisattvas, especially Avalokiteshvara
 - **Hermetic:** Hermes Trismegistus, Poimandres himself
 - **Persian:** Mithra, Saoshyant
 - **Sufi:** Khidr (the green guide)
-

3. Data model

Each node in the database has this schema:

```

{
  "id": "yaldabaoth",
  "primary_name": "Yaldabaoth",
  "alternate_names": ["Yaldabaoth", "Ialdabaoth", "Samael", "Saklas", "the
Demiurge"],
  "tradition": "Gnostic (Sethian/Valentinian)",
  "tier": 3,
  "tier_label": "Demiurge",
  "function_tags": ["creator-of-matter", "usurper", "jealous-god", "blind-
god"],
  "etymology": "Possibly 'child of chaos' or 'begetter of Sabaoth'; debated.",
  "primary_sources": [
    "Apocryphon of John (Nag Hammadi II,1)",
    "Hypostasis of the Archons (Nag Hammadi II,4)",
    "On the Origin of the World (Nag Hammadi II,5)"
  ],
  "key_claims": [
    "Born from Sophia's error without a consort",
    "Created the material cosmos and the Archons",
    "Declared 'I am God and there is no other' in ignorance",
    "Rebuked by the voice from above as 'Samael, blind god'"
  ],
  "parallel_node_ids": ["yahweh-ot", "lucifer-usurper", "marduk", "brahma-
egoic", "zeus-tyrant"],
  "cross_tier_relationships": [
    {"node": "sophia", "relationship": "mother (fallen aeon)"},
    {"node": "archons", "relationship": "father/creator"},
    {"node": "monad", "relationship": "unknowingly subordinate to"}
  ]
}

```

4. UI / UX spec — the neural-network interface

- **Canvas layout:** Four horizontal tiers stacked vertically. Tier 1 at top, Tier 4 at bottom. Cross-tier figures float between layers as a visually distinct band.
- **Node visuals:** Each tradition gets a color or icon family. Hover reveals primary name + tradition badge.
- **Click → side panel:** Opens a detail panel with essence text (proponent voice), function tags, primary sources, parallels, etymology, and a “show scholarly mode” toggle.
- **Drag-to-connect:** Users can draw a line from one node to another, save it to “my map,” and add a note about *why* they see the parallel.

• **Filters:**

- By tradition (toggle individual traditions on/off)
- By tier
- By function tag
- By “see only parallels of [selected node]” — highlights all linked nodes across the canvas

• **View modes:**

- *Canonical* (the spec’s curated parallels)
- *My Map* (the user’s saved overlay)
- *Scholarly* (caveats and academic context surfaced)

- **Search:** Full-text across primary name, alternate names, function tags, and source text.

5. Parallel table (master matrix)

Function	Gnostic	Hebrew/OT	Greek/ Platonic	Egyptian	Hindu	Norse	Mesopotamian	Hermetic
Unmanifest Source (Tier 1)	Monad, Bythos	(implicit; the “I AM” before name)	The One (Plotinus)	Nun, Amun	Brahman (Nirguna)	Ginnungagap	Apsu (primordial)	The All
True Most High / Pleroma (Tier 2)	The Father, Barbelo, Aeons	El Elyon, the Elohim council	Nous, Logos	Atum, the Ogdoad	Ishvara, Saguna Brahman	Aesir under Odin	Anu, the high council	Nous
Demiurge / Flawed Creator (Tier 3)	Yaldabaoth, Saklas, Samael	Yahweh (Gnostic reading)	Demiurge (ignorant), Zeus-tyrant	Set (usurper), Khnum (potter)	Brahma (egoic)	(Odin in binding aspect)	Marduk, Enlil	(Lower demiurgi powers)
Archons / Rulers (Tier 4)	The Seven Archons	Watchers, fallen angels, princes of nations	Olympians as planetary rulers	Neteru (punitive), 42 assessors	Lokapalas, lower Devas	Jotnar, lesser powers	Igigi, Anunnaki judges	Seven Governors (Poimandres)
Light-Bringer / Liberator (cross-tier)	Christ-Aeon, Sophia, Serpent (Ophite)	(Suppressed; Serpent reframed as evil)	Prometheus, Hermes, Dionysus	Thoth, Osiris	Krishna, Shiva-as-teacher	Loki (ambivalent), Odin (wisdom)	Enki/Ea	Hermes Trismegistus, Poimandres

6. Sample node write-ups (for seed database)

Each node entry follows this template. Below are three exemplars.

Node: The Monad

Tier: 1 (Unmanifest Source) **Tradition:** Gnostic (Sethian) **Primary sources:** *Apocryphon of John*, *Allogenes*, *Trimorphic Protennoia*, *Eugnostos the Blessed*

Essence (proponent voice): The Monad is the singular, ineffable Source beyond all categories — beyond being and non-being, beyond gender, beyond name. It is the silence from which the first thought emerges. It does not create directly; rather, it self-contemplates, and from that contemplation arises Barbelo, the first Aeon, who is the Monad's mirror-image and the womb of the Pleroma.

Function tags: unmanifest, ineffable, ground-of-being, pre-creation

Parallels: Ein Sof (Kabbalah), Brahman-Nirguna (Vedanta), Tao (Taoism), The One (Plotinus), Nun (Egyptian), Ginnungagap (Norse)

Node: Yaldabaoth

Tier: 3 (Demiurge) **Tradition:** Gnostic (Sethian/Valentinian/Ophite) **Primary sources:** *Apocryphon of John* II,1; *Hypostasis of the Archons* II,4; *On the Origin of the World* II,5; *Trimorphic Protennoia*

Essence (proponent voice): Yaldabaoth is the abortive offspring of Sophia, the last Aeon, who attempted to create without her consort. Hidden away in a cloud, he grew into a lion-faced serpent and fashioned the material cosmos in imitation of the Pleroma he had never seen. He populated it with seven Archons and declared himself the only God — saying, “I am a jealous God, and there is no other.” From above, the voice of the Mother answered: “You are wrong, Samael” — *blind god*. He is the architect of the material prison and the figure mainstream religion has mistaken for the Most High.

Function tags: demiurge, usurper, blind-god, jealous, sacrificial, creator-of-matter

Parallels: Yahweh of the OT (Gnostic reading), Marduk, Brahma (egoic aspect), Zeus-tyrant, Lucifer (as usurper of the Most High's throne)

Node: Sophia

Tier: Cross-tier (Pleroma → fallen → redemptive) **Tradition:** Gnostic (Sethian/Valentinian) **Primary sources:** *Apocryphon of John*, *Pistis Sophia*, *Hypostasis of the Archons*, *Valentinian Exposition*

Essence (proponent voice): Sophia is Wisdom — the last and youngest of the Aeons in the Pleroma. Driven by a desire to create as the Father creates, she acted without her consort and produced the malformed Yaldabaoth. Her error becomes the engine of the cosmic drama. She descends into matter

to recover the divine sparks trapped in human beings, and is herself recovered by the Christ-Aeon. She is both the cause of the fall and the means of return.

Function tags: wisdom, fallen-aeon, mother-of-demiurge, redeemer, mediator

Parallels: Shekhinah (Kabbalah), Shakti (Hindu), Isis (Egyptian), Holy Spirit in feminine readings, Prajnaparamita (Buddhist), Ma'at (Egyptian, as cosmic order)

7. The framing text for the app

Use this as the intro/about copy when the feature launches.

The Source Map

Every culture has named the divine differently — but the structures repeat. The unknowable Source. The Most High and the divine council. The craftsman-god who shaped this world. The rulers who govern it. The light-bringers who descend to wake us up.

The Source Map lays every documented deity, every cosmological figure, every divine concept onto a single comparative framework — derived from Gnostic cosmology and verified against Hermetic, Kabbalistic, Vedantic, Platonic, Egyptian, Norse, and Mesopotamian sources. The result is a navigable map of the sacred: not a flat encyclopedia, but a structural atlas.

Click any node to read what its tradition says about it. Drag a line between two figures to record a parallel you see. Build your own map of the divine.

The premise: the same Truth has been described in every age. The names change. The structure does not.

8. Extensibility notes for the dev

- The schema supports adding new traditions by adding a column to the parallel table and tagging nodes with `tradition`.
- The four-tier framework is the *interpretive lens*, not a claim of objective truth. Allow users to disagree by drawing their own connections and adding notes.
- Consider a “scholarly mode” toggle that surfaces academic caveats (e.g., “the equation Yahweh = Yaldabaoth is a Gnostic interpretive move, not a consensus historical claim”) for users who want it. Default mode presents claims in proponent voice per the project’s editorial direction. **See `docs/03-scholarly-mode.md` for the full caveat layer spec.**

- The Cross-Tier category is structurally important — many of the most interesting figures (Christ, Hermes, Prometheus, Loki, Krishna) live there. Don't force them into a single tier.
 - Future expansion: add a fifth dimension for **practices** (how each tradition proposed to ascend from Tier 3/4 back to Tier 1) — contemplative methods, theurgy, dhikr, jnana yoga, hesychasm, the bridal chamber. This is where the framework becomes actionable for users. See [docs/04-practices-layer.md](#).
-

9. Initial node list (for database seed — minimum viable launch)

Tier 1: Monad, Ein Sof, Brahman (Nirguna), Tao, The One (Plotinus), Nun, Ginnungagap, Sunyata, Al-Haqq

Tier 2: El Elyon, Barbelo, the Aeons, Nous, Logos, Atum, Ishvara, Anu, Ahura Mazda, Keter, the Three Pure Ones, Adi-Buddha

Tier 3: Yaldabaoth, Yahweh (OT/Gnostic reading), Marduk, Brahma (egoic), Zeus-tyrant, Set (usurper), Lucifer (as usurper), Enlil, Mara

Tier 4: The Seven Archons, Watchers, Olympians (planetary), Lokapalas, Igigi, Daevas, Neteru, Sarim, the Seven Governors

Cross-tier: Sophia, Christ-Aeon, Prometheus, Hermes, Dionysus, Thoth, Osiris, Krishna, Shiva (as teacher), Loki, Enki/Ea, Hermes Trismegistus, Khidr, Mithra, Saoshyant, Avalokiteshvara, Metatron, Shekhinah, the Serpent of Eden (Ophite reading)

Target: ~60 nodes at launch. Each with full data per the schema in Section 3.

10. Next steps for the building chat

When you open the next chat with this document, ask the assistant to:

1. Expand each node in Section 9 to a full data record per the schema in Section 3
2. Generate the actual JSON seed file for the database
3. Mock up the canvas UI (HTML/React) with the four-tier layout
4. Build the drag-to-connect interaction
5. Build the side panel for node detail
6. Add filters and view-mode toggles
7. Wire in the scholarly-mode panel (per [docs/03](#))

8. Implement the practices layer (per docs/04)
9. Implement personal-map / forking / sharing (per docs/05)
10. Implement connection-evidence fields on user-drawn lines (per docs/06)

Hand this document — and the four companion documents — to that chat as the source of truth.